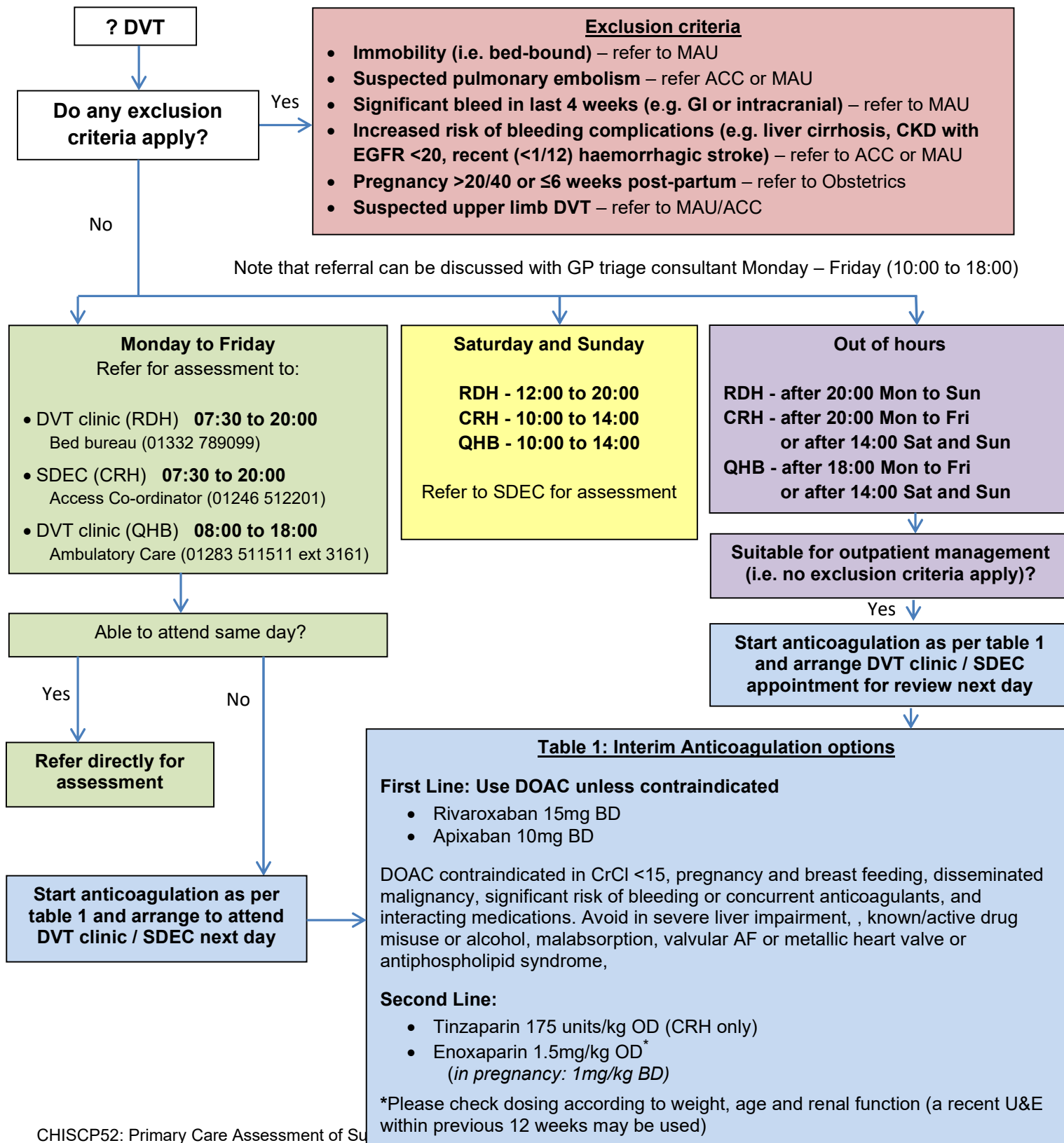


Derbyshire Shared Care Pathology Guidelines

Primary Care Management of Suspected DVT

The D-dimer test has a high false positive rate and is non-specific.
It should NOT be used in primary care.



Contacts

Bed Bureau RDH 01332 789099 or via switchboard
Access Co-ordinator CRH 01246 512201
Ambulatory Care QHB 01283 511511 ext 3161

References

NICE NG158. Venous thromboembolic diseases: diagnosis, management and thrombophilia testing (Updated Aug 2023)

SPC Xalero <https://www.medicines.org.uk/emc/product/2793/smpc#INDICATIONS>
accessed 17/08/2020

SPC Eliquis <https://www.medicines.org.uk/emc/product/2878/smpc> accessed 17/08/2020

Authors: Dr P Blackwell, Mrs H Seddon, Dr A McKernan, Dr Liz Mullaney, December 2017		
Reviewed by:	Date:	Expiry date:
Dr Tom Livingston, Dr Penny Blackwell, Dr Mansur Reza, Dr Seema Kumari, Mrs Helen Seddon	July 2020	31 st July 2022
Dr Tom Livingston, Dr Penny Blackwell, Dr Mansur Reza, Mrs Helen Seddon	Dec 2022	31 st Dec 2024
Dr Tom Livingston, Dr Penny Blackwell, Dr M Memon, Ms H Chaplin, Dr C Kartsios, Dr Mansur Reza, Ms S Knowles	Mar 2025	31 st March 2027

Appendix 1- Two- level DVT Wells score

Clinical Feature	Points
Active cancer (treatment ongoing, within 6 months, or palliative)	1
Paralysis, paresis or recent plaster immobilisation of the lower extremities	1
Recently bedridden for 3 days or more or major surgery within 12 weeks requiring general or regional anaesthesia	1
Localised tenderness along the distribution of the deep venous system	1
Entire leg swollen	1
Calf swelling at least 3 cm larger than asymptomatic side	1
Pitting oedema confined to the symptomatic leg	1
Collateral superficial veins (non-varicose)	1
Previously documented DVT	1
Alternative diagnosis at least as likely as DVT	-2
Clinical probability simplified score	
DVT 'likely'	2 points or more
DVT 'unlikely'	Less than 2 points

Wells PS, Anderson DR, Rodger M, Forgie M, Kearon C, Dreyer J et al. Evaluation of D-dimer in the diagnosis of suspected deep-vein thrombosis. *New England Journal of Medicine*. 2003; 349(13):1227–1235

Appendix 2- Prescribing Information

DOAC used for suspected DVT is off-label. Edoxaban and Dabigatran have not been included in this guideline as their licensing for treating DVT includes a period of using LMWH.		
Drug	Apixaban	Rivaroxaban
Initial dosage	10mg twice daily	15 mg twice daily
Quantity	Initially prescribe until scheduled ultrasound scan date. Note- Only add to patients records as an acute prescription.	
Dose for confirmed DVT (as advised by secondary care)	10mg twice daily for the first 7 days Followed by 5mg twice daily	15mg twice daily for day 1-21 Followed by 20mg once daily
	If DVT confirmed and treatment continued, specify treatment length or review date on repeat prescription.	
Renal impairment	Creatinine clearance 15-29 mL/min- to be used with caution	Creatinine clearance 15 - 49 mL/min- 15 mg BD for the first 3 weeks, then consider reducing to 15 mg OD <i>if bleeding risk outweighs the risk for recurrent DVT and PE*</i> .
Patient Counselling <i>ensure patient has DOAC card</i>	- Off-licensed use prior to confirmation of diagnosis - Importance of compliance with treatment - May need to have regular blood test to check renal function - That if they require surgery they may have to stop DOAC treatment temporarily. - To seek immediate medical advice if spontaneous bleeding occurs and does not stop, or recurs; or if they get sudden severe back pain (may indicate spontaneous retroperitoneal bleeding). - Not to take over-the-counter medicines such as nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs. - What to do if there has been a missed dose or if a double dose has been taken. CRHFT counselling video for patients newly started on DOAC. Link	
Administration	Can be taken with or without food	Must be taken with food
	For swallowing difficulty/ enteral tubes see local AF guideline	

* The recommendation for the use of 15 mg is based on PK modelling and has not been studied in this clinical setting

For Low Molecular weight heparin see JAPC [LMWH prescribing guideline \(Enoxaparin and Tinzaparin\)](#)